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Amid the carnage in Gujarat, the redeeming feature was the mature response of Chief Minister Narendra Modi, in contrast to his public image.

they were not intended to cause large-scale destruction. They were planted around two main roads of Bangalore, the Hosur Road and the Mysore Road, and were believed to have been planted three days earlier. None of the type of bombs used in Ahmedabad (*see graphic*) would have survived three days in Bangalore's rainy weather, they would have exploded or the humidity would have rendered them useless. The bombs were extremely rudimentary devices, made of ammonium nitrate and urea, but what has flummoxed the police is the use of a high-tech micro-chip which has not been used in any of the blasts in India so far. The micro-chip has data programmed to go off at a set date and time. Officials also point to the coincidence that the cities attacked this time are in BJP-ruled states. Karnataka Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa says, "It seems

someone is trying to send us a message."

That was clearly the case in Gujarat where the redeeming feature was the mature response of Chief Minister Modi. He was prompt to call in the army and his public statement made a deep impact: "We should maintain peace and order and face this challenge unitedly to destroy the evil designs of the enemies of the nation." When Congress President Sonia Gandhi and Prime Minister Manmohan Singh came to visit the victims in hospital, his response was equally measured. He gave a memorandum to the prime minister underlining the need for an IPS-like national cadre for intelligence gathering and reviving the POTA to deter terrorists. He also appealed to the Centre to pass the Gujarat Control of Organised Crime bill 2003, enacted by his government. It has been awaiting the Centre's nod for quite some time.

BUMPY ROAD AHEAD: Home Minister Shivraj Patil guides Sonia Gandhi through rain puddles in Ahmedabad